CHLORINATION UNITS: SAFETY AND HANDLING

The safety rules for working on sodium hypochlorite dosing units. Hypochlorite is corrosive, releases chlorine gas when mixed with acid, and degrades in light and heat. Nobody works on a unit alone who has not completed the chlorination module of the field safety training.

Personal protective equipment

Chemical splash goggles, nitrile gauntlets and a chemical apron for any work on the day tank, the dosing pump or the lines. An eyewash station is within ten metres of every unit and is checked at every visit.

Work a field technician does not carry out alone

Three tasks are outside the visiting technician's scope and are done by the laboratory or by two people with a permit. The analyser calibration is carried out by the laboratory, because it sets the dose the network receives. Bulk delivery of hypochlorite is received by two people, never one. And any work inside the bund, including cleaning a spill, needs a permit to work and a second person present. A technician who finds a spill records it, closes the bund drain, and calls the control room.

Spills and exposure

Skin contact is rinsed for fifteen minutes. Eye contact is rinsed at the eyewash for fifteen minutes and the technician goes to hospital, whatever they think of it. A spill outside the bund is a water quality incident and is reported to the control room before anything else.

Storage

Day tanks are kept out of sunlight and below 25 degrees. Hypochlorite older than the date on the delivery note is not used; its strength is unknown and the dose will be wrong.